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opportunities in the Indian economy, there have been steady increase in the prices of essential goods. The continuous rise in prices erodes the purchasing power and adversely affects the poor people, whose income is not protected.

4. Weak Infrastructure

Even though there has been a gradual improvement in the infrastructural development in the past few decades, there is still a scarcity of the basic infrastructure like power, transport, storage etc.

5. Inadequate Employment generation

With growing youth population, there is a huge need of the employment opportunities. The growth in production is not accompanied by creation of job. The Indian economy is characterized by 'jobless growth'.

6. Outdated technology

The level of technology in agriculture and small scale industries is still outdated and obsolete.

7.3.3 Demographic trends in India

Scientific study of the characteristics of population is known as Demography. The various aspects **of demographic trends in India are:**

- Size of population
- Rate of growth
- Birth and death rates
- Density of population
- Sex-ratio
- Life-expectancy at birth
- Literacy ratio

a. Size of Population

Table 7.1 Population Growth

Census Year	Population (in crores)	Average annual growth rate
1901	23.84	-
1911	25.21	0.56
1921	25.13	-0.03
1931	27.90	1.04
1941	31.87	1.33
1951	36.11	1.25
1961	43.92	1.96
1971	54.81	2.20
1981	68.33	2.22
1991	84.33	2.16
2001	102.70	1.97
2011	121.02	1.66

(Source: Registrar General of India)

Over a period of 100 years, India has quadrupled its population size. In terms of, size of population, India ranks 2nd in the world after China. India has only about 2.4% of the world's geographical area and contributes less than 1.2% of the world's income, but accommodates about 17.5% of the world's population. In other words, every 6th person in the world is an Indian. Infact, the combined population of just two states namely, Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra is more than the population of United States of America, the third most populous country of the world. Some of the states in India have larger population than many countries in the world.